



SUCCESS SKILL: COLLABORATION

BACKGROUND

This rubric is aligned to the [NCIES literature review](#) on collaboration. The value proposition is a clear research-based definition of collaboration as a success skill. This research-based rubric¹ is designed to provide useful, formative information that teachers can use to guide instruction and provide feedback to students and that they can use to reflect on the quality of their peer interactions. In this rubric, student performance is described along a continuum and balances content-specific and the more general nature of collaboration. Rubrics are provided by grade span, K-2, 3-5, and 6-12. The K-2 rubric includes both a teacher version and a version for primary students or early readers. The research-based definition of collaboration, identified in the literature review, embraces the concept of *collaboration as a process*:

“Students work in groups to improve their ability to work with others, and the quality of student interactions therefore should be the focus of teaching and learning. To be sure, intellectual gain and increased academic content knowledge and skill could be a bi- or co-product of collaborative activity, but this is not the focus either of instruction or of assessment related to collaboration. Rather, the focus is on the nature and quality of the collaborative activity and the interactions among group members” (Evans, 2020, p5).

BUILDING COLLABORATION SKILLS THROUGH CULTURALLY- RELEVANT GOLD STANDARD PBL

- **Use Gold Standard Project Based Teaching Practices to support students’ development of collaborative skills within a project.** Teachers can build a culture of collaboration by explicitly and implicitly promoting student interdependence and growth, open-ended inquiry, teamwork, and attention to quality. To manage activities, teachers work with students to organize tasks and schedules, set checkpoints and deadlines, find and use resources, and create products. Within the context of a project, teachers also intentionally scaffold [collaboration skills](#) through targeted instruction, tools, and practices that help students learn and practice strategies for working well together in teams. Throughout the project, teachers monitor and regulate student interactions to gather evidence of collaboration. [PBLWorks Strategy Guides](#) located on [my.pblworks.org](#) offer multiple resources to address instructional strategies that support collaboration.
- **Use research-based guidance to assess collaboration.** Throughout the project, teachers monitor and support student interactions to gather evidence of collaboration. To assess the quality of student interactions, Evans (2020) suggests that tasks need to:
 - **Be sufficiently complex.** Make the design rigorous and frame it with a challenging problem or meaningful question at the appropriate level of challenge. The design should be challenging enough to elicit group discussion, negotiation, and collective efforts.
 - **Be open-ended.** Tasks that are open-ended require students to determine what is relevant, plan how they will demonstrate their knowledge, and offer multiple pathways for solutions. Open-ended tasks “allow for multiple, defensible solutions and, further, require students to apply (or transfer) their learning to novel situations” (p. 18).
 - **Be authentic.** Using the Gold Standard Design Element, Authenticity, in project design provides students with opportunities to engage with real-world contexts, tasks, tools, or impact. The PBLWorks Blog, [What Does it Take for a Project to be “Authentic”?](#) is a helpful resource for planning.
 - **Be reflective of culture and context.** [PBL supports culturally responsive teaching practices](#), and it is important to note that while assessing the quality of student interactions cultural differences must be considered. Some differences are verbal, what is considered appropriate communication and sharing of resources, ideas, or efforts; other differences are non-verbal and mediate what is considered appropriate body language, conflict resolution, and task management tactics. Verbal and non-verbal interactions may vary across cultural contexts.
 - **Make student thinking visible.** Offer students opportunities to make their thinking visible to their group. Use [Structured reflections](#) to do this.

¹ These rubrics were created by National Center for Improvement of Educational Assessment (Center for Assessment) in collaboration with PBLWorks. This version of the rubric integrates asset-based language based on the *Ready for Rigor: A Framework for Culturally Responsive Teaching* (Hammond, 2013).



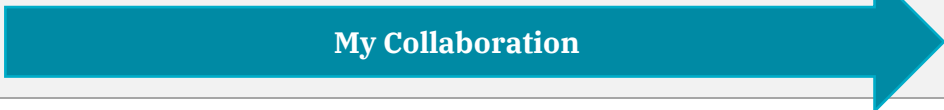
Collaboration Rubric Grade K-2 (For Teachers)

Collaboration occurs when students work together to complete a project and must combine thinking, skills, and efforts to do so.

DIMENSION				
	<i>Select the column where most of the criteria describe what a student knows and can do independently.</i>			
	BEGINNING	EMERGING	DEVELOPING	DEMONSTRATING
Planning and Group Decision-Making	• Focuses on their own way to do the project. • Does work in any way that they like. • Expresses frustration if someone offers suggestions for how to do the work.	• Retells how others in the group want to complete the project. • Tells others when they want to help. • Self-manages if others in the group offer suggestions or express frustration about work.	• Shares ideas about the project plan, when asked. • Offers how they can best help the group. • Helps others who are having trouble with the work, when asked.	• Shares ideas about how the group can work together to complete the project. • Suggests how others can help. • Uses classroom norms, rituals, or routines to support others with the work.
Communicating About Thinking	• Discussion is focused on their own ideas.	• Restates the ideas that are shared by others.	• Asks questions to help clarify the ideas of others.	• Asks what others think. • Uses academic language to talk about their learning moves.
Contributing Resources, Ideas, and Efforts	• Does their own work using resources that were given.	• Identifies what they need to complete the work. • Asks group for help or resources when needed. • Shares work with others.	• Shares ideas with the group. • Finds resources for others, when asked. • Asks others if they need help.	• Suggests ideas to help improve the project. • Provides resources to support the group. • Helps others and gives feedback during the project.
Monitoring Processes	• Focuses on getting their own work or tasks done.	• Identifies how their own work shows quality.	• Monitors the quality and progress of their own work. • Brainstorms how the group can do better next time.	• Reflects on the quality and progress of the overall project. • Brainstorms how they and their group could do better next time.



EXAMPLE Collaboration Rubric: Grade K-2 For Students

QUESTION	 My Collaboration			
	<i>Show what you know and can do independently.</i>			
	BEGINNING	EMERGING	DEVELOPING	DEMONSTRATING
How do I contribute to group decisions?	● I focus mostly on my way to do the work.	● I share how my group wants to complete the project. ● I share when I want to help. ● I listen when my group has suggestions or frustrations about the work.	● I share ideas about the project plan when I am asked. ● I share how I could help my group. ● I help others when I am asked.	● I share ideas about how my group could work together to complete the project. ● I offer suggestions on how others could help. ● I use strategies I learned in class to help my group.
How do I communicate about the work?	● I talk mostly about my own ideas.	● I repeat the ideas that others shared.	● I ask questions to help clarify others' ideas.	● I ask what others in my group think. ● I use vocabulary that I learned to talk about the work.
How do I share resources and ideas?	● I mostly use the resources that I was given.	● I share what I needed to complete my work. ● I ask my group for help or resources when needed. ● I share my work with others.	● I share my ideas with the group. ● I find resources for others when asked. ● I ask others if they need help.	● I share ideas to help make our work better. ● I share resources to help my group. ● I help others. ● I give feedback.
How do I reflect on the work?	● I mostly focus on getting my own work done.	● I share what is good about my work.	● I share what is good about my work and how it is going. ● I help brainstorm how my group can do better next time.	● I reflect on what is good about the overall project and how it went. ● I brainstorm how both me and my group could do better next time.